

# Probability basics

**Q1.** A die is rolled. What is the probability of getting:

- (a) An even number
- (b) A number greater than 4

**Ans.** (a)

a) Probability of getting an even number

The favourable outcomes for getting an even number are  $E_1 = \{2, 4, 6\}$ .

The number of favourable outcomes is  $n(E_1) = 3$ .

The probability  $P(E_1)$  is calculated

$$P(E_1) = \frac{n(E_1)}{n(S)}$$
$$P(E_1) = \frac{3}{6}$$
$$P(E_1) = \frac{1}{2} = 0.5$$

(b)

(b) Probability of getting a number greater than 4

The favorable outcomes for getting a number greater than 4 are  $E_2 = \{5, 6\}$ .

The number of favourable outcomes is  $n(E_2) = 2$ .

The probability  $P(E_2)$  is calculated as

$$P(E_2) = \frac{n(E_2)}{n(S)}$$
$$P(E_2) = \frac{2}{6}$$
$$P(E_2) = \frac{1}{3} \approx 0.333$$

**Q2.** In a class of 50 students:

20 like Mathematics (M)

15 like Science (S)

5 like both subjects

What is the probability that a student chosen at random likes Mathematics or Science?

**Ans.** The probability that a student chosen at random likes Mathematics or Science is

$\frac{3}{5}$  or 0.6 (60%).

1. Find the number of students who like mathematics or science.

$$n(\text{Musci}) = n(M) + n(S) - n(M \cap S)$$
$$n(\text{Musci}) = 20 + 15 - 5$$
$$n(\text{Musci}) = 30$$

2. Calculate the probability.

$$P(\text{Musci}) = \frac{n(\text{Musci})}{n(S)}$$
$$P(\text{Musci}) = \frac{30}{50}$$

Simplifying the fraction:

$$P(\text{Musci}) = \frac{3}{5} = 0.6$$

**Q3.** A bag has 3 red and 2 blue balls. If one ball is drawn randomly and is red, what is the probability that the next ball is also red (without replacement)?

**Ans.** Remaining red balls =  $3 - 1 = 2$

Remaining Total balls =  $5 - 1 = 4$

Calculation:

$$P(\text{Second red} \mid \text{First red}) = \frac{\text{Remaining Red}}{\text{Remaining Total}}$$

$$P = \frac{2}{4}$$

Final Ans :

The probability that the next ball is also red is  $\frac{1}{2}$  or 0.5 (50%)

**Q4.** The population of a school is divided into 60% boys and 40% girls. If you want equal representation of both genders in the sample, which method should you use: Simple Random Sampling or Stratified Sampling? Why?

**Ans.** Sampling Method Selection

The correct method to use is Stratified Random Sampling.

Reasoning:

1. Group Division (Strata): This method allows you to divide the population into two specific groups (strata): Boys and Girls.
2. Guaranteed Representation: Unlike Simple Random Sampling, where the 60/40 split in the population might lead to a biased sample by chance, Stratified Sampling allows you to deliberately select an equal number (50% each) from both groups.
3. Accuracy: It ensures that the smaller group (girls) is not underrepresented, providing equal statistical weight to both genders.

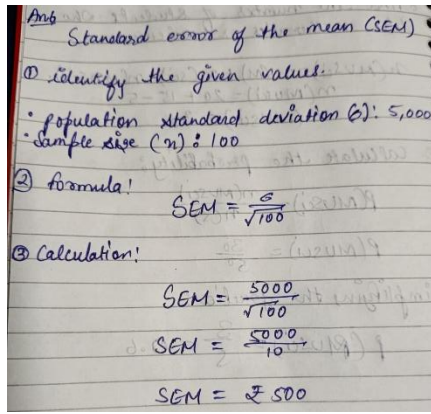
**Q5.** The average height of 1000 students = 160 cm. A sample of 100 students shows an average height = 158 cm. Find the sampling error.

**Ans.** Sampling Error =  $160 \text{ cm} - 158 \text{ cm}$

Sampling Error = 2cm

**Q6.** The population mean salary is ₹50,000 with  $\sigma = ₹5,000$ . If we take a sample of 100 employees, what is the standard error of the mean (SEM)?

Ans6.



The Standard Error (₹500) represents the average amount that the sample mean is expected to vary from the actual population mean. A lower SEM indicates that the sample mean is a more accurate reflection of the true population mean.

**Q7.** In a group of 100 students:

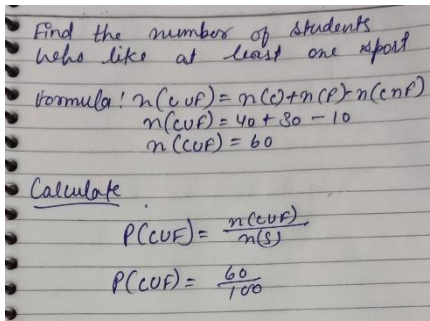
40 like Cricket (C)

30 like Football (F)

10 like both Cricket and Football

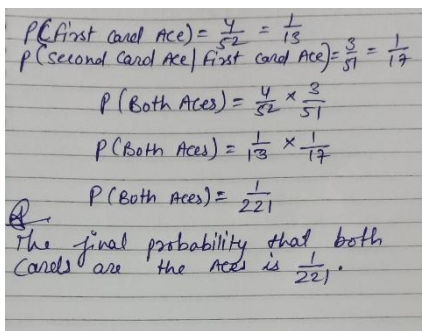
Find the probability that a student likes at least one sport.

**Ans7.** The probability that a student likes at least one sport is 0.6 or 60%.



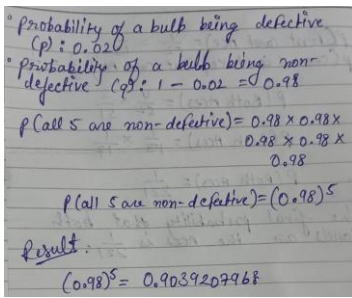
**Q8.** From a deck of 52 cards, two cards are drawn without replacement. What is the probability that both are Aces?

Ans.



**Q9.** A factory produces bulbs with 2% defective rate. If 5 bulbs are chosen at random, what is the probability that all are non-defective?

**Ans9.**



Handwritten solution for Q9:

- Probability of a bulb being defective ( $p$ ) = 0.02
- Probability of a bulb being non-defective ( $q$ ) =  $1 - 0.02 = 0.98$
- $P(\text{all 5 are non-defective}) = 0.98 \times 0.98 \times 0.98 \times 0.98 \times 0.98$
- $P(\text{all 5 are non-defective}) = (0.98)^5$
- Result:  $(0.98)^5 = 0.9039207968$

The probability that all 5 bulbs are non-defective is approximately 0.9039 (or 90.39%).

**Q10.** Differentiate between discrete and continuous random variables with examples.

**Ans.** The Core Difference

- Discrete: Values you count. They are separate, distinct numbers (usually integers).
- Continuous: Values you measure. They can be any number (including decimals) within a range.

**DRIVE LINK:** [https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1ZlFjacMcn7A-Gi0Qmzbq18jmXQvYluqH?usp=drive\\_link](https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1ZlFjacMcn7A-Gi0Qmzbq18jmXQvYluqH?usp=drive_link)